Respectful and constructive feedback

Is feedback respectful and intellectually serious?

RESPECT / ASSESSMENT

ONE-PAGE TEACHING GUIDE

WHAT IS IT?

Feedback is given with courtesy and intellectual seriousness

WHY DOES IT MATTER?

Teaching is never neutral. Choices about readings, cases, examples, guest speakers, classroom norms and professional pathways tell students whose lives and knowledge are considered normal, legitimate or peripheral. When students cannot recognise themselves or their communities in the discipline, participation can start to feel risky or pointless.

THE STUDENT EXPERIENCE

- “People like me do not seem to exist in this field.”
- “We only appear when the course is discussing disadvantage or a problem.”

HOW CAN I DO IT?

- Write feedback as if speaking to a capable learner, not sorting them into worthiness categories.
- Name what is working as well as the next step.
- Avoid unnecessary shaming language or tone.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

Instead of “weak analysis”, feedback identifies the promising idea and the specific move needed to strengthen the reasoning.

STARTING POINT TO ADAPT

For this assessment, we aim to provide feedback that is respectful, specific and intellectually serious while still supporting improvement. The learning outcomes being assessed are [insert outcomes].

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Designing assessment

Creating and using rubrics